



AFRICAN-DIASPORA NURSING ALLIANCE

Global US Conference 2026

CONFERENCE AGENDA

“Voices of Change: Translating Innovation into Action for Global Health”

August 21–22, 2026 · Johns Hopkins School of Nursing

525 N. Wolfe Street, Baltimore, Maryland 21205

www.a-dna.org , www.g-dna.org

DAY ONE Friday, August 21, 2026

TIME	SESSION	FORMAT	LOCATION
8:00 AM	Conference Registration, Visit Exhibits & Welcome Breakfast	REGISTRATION	LOBBY & HUB
8:45 AM	Opening Remarks, Dr. Nana Yaa Addai, US Country Director, African-Diaspora Nursing Alliance	WELCOME	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM
8:50 AM	Welcome Remarks. Dr. Nancy Reynolds Director, Johns Hopkins School of Nursing Center for Global Initiatives, Advisor, African-Diaspora Nursing Alliance	WELCOME	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM
9:00 AM – 9:30 AM	No Bed, No Excuse: Closing Africa’s Emergency Care Gap Through Multidisciplinary Collaboration and Diaspora-Driven Innovation KEYNOTE SPEAKER Dr. Bertha Serwaa Ayi	KEYNOTE	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM

TIME	SESSION	FORMAT	LOCATION
9:30 AM – 11:00 AM	No Bed, No Excuse: Closing Africa’s Emergency Care Gap Through Multidisciplinary Collaboration and Diaspora-Driven Innovation MODERATOR —Ms. Angela Agore , UK Country Director, Ghanaian-Diaspora Nursing Alliance (G-DNA) PANELISTS — Dr. Bertha Serwaa Ayi , Former President, Ghana Physicians and Surgeons Foundation (GPSF) — Emmanuel Acheampong , Nurse Lead, African Federation for Emergency Medicine; Registered Emergency Nurse, Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital, Ghana — Dr. Patience Afulani , National Vice President, Ghana Physicians and Surgeons Foundation (GPSF) — Dr. Tegan Lukacs , Associate Professor of Emergency Medicine, Johns Hopkins Medicine, Center for Global Emergency Care — Dr. Esther Peter , President, National Association of Nigerian Nurses in North America (NANNA), DMV Chapter	PANEL	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM
11:00 AM – 11:15 AM	Break / Visit Exhibits	BREAK	HUB
11:15 AM – 12:15 PM	Concurrent Breakout Sessions — Morning <i>Choose one</i> A Advancing Advanced Practice: Training & Integrating APN and Specialist Roles in African Healthcare Systems Dr. Rita D’Aoust · Dr. Daniel Apau · Dr. Matilda Decker · Dr. Brenda Owusu, Dr. Brenda Vardon	BREAKOUT	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM
	B Status-Neutral HIV/ID Care: Practical Primary Care Strategies for Local and Global Health Dr. Melonie Owusu · Trina Scott		CARPENTER A
	C From Evidence to Action: Transforming Postpartum Care Globally to Save Lives Dr. Janet Williams · Ann Bonti		CARPENTER B
	D Accurate Blood Pressure Measurement in the Community and Clinic Dr. Faith Metlock. Dr. Yvonne Commodore-Mensah		N130 &N140

TIME	SESSION	FORMAT	LOCATION
12:15 PM – 1:15 PM	Lunch, Networking & Visit Exhibits	LUNCH & EXHIBITS	FOYER
12:30 PM – 1:15 PM	Poster Presentations	POSTERS	HUB
1:15 PM – 2:00 PM	Oral Presentations Olufunmilola Faminu — <i>Perception of labour pain and willingness to use pain relief among pregnant women attending the antenatal clinic at UCH, Nigeria</i> James Aryiku — <i>"Nothing About Us Without Us": An Innovative Tri-System Model for Advancing Student Voice & Equity in Ghanaian University Mental Health Systems</i> Anna Mensah-Nti — <i>Effectiveness of the Myself Model: A Nurse-Led Intervention to Reduce Cultural Stigmatization Among Older Immigrants Receiving HCBS</i>	ORAL PRESENTATIONS	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM
2:00 PM – 3:20 PM	Translating Ethical Recruitment into Reinvestment: Innovation and Partnership Models in Global Healthcare Workforce Mobility OPENING REMARKS Ambassador Mrs. Jane Gasu Aheto, Esq., Deputy Ambassador of Ghana to the United States of America FEATURED PRESENTATION Dr. Peter Preziosi, Chief Executive Officer, Trumerit PANELISTS — Dr. Manjula Luthria , Senior Labor Economist, World Bank — Amber Sprengard , Vice President, Government Affairs, Health Carousel Foundation — Perpetual Ofori-Ampofo , President, Ghana Registered Nurses and Midwives Association (GRNMA) — Dr. Deborah Baker , Senior Vice President for Nursing, Johns Hopkins Health System — Melissa Ryan Kemburu , Senior Advisor, Health Resources and Services Administration (HRSA)	KEYNOTE <i>Sponsored by Trumerit</i>	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM

TIME	SESSION	FORMAT	LOCATION
3:30 PM	Concurrent Breakout Sessions — Afternoon <i>Choose one</i> A Building Wealth with Purpose: Financial Literacy for Healthcare Professionals MODERATOR — Eunice Adu, Founder, Peniel Healthcare PANELISTS — Dr. Eugenia Caternor, Founder, Transformational Center for Weight Loss — Mr. Terry English, Founder, Vigilant Healthcare Solutions — Anna Mensah-Nti, President/CEO Access Home Care, Inc., Access Medical Institute & Technology	BREAKOUT	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM
	B Intelligence for Impact: Leveraging AI & Machine Learning to Strengthen the African Health Workforce FACILITATORS — Dr. Thomas Osborne, Chief Medical Officer, Microsoft — James Leuthe, Scopewell Solutions		CARPENTER A
	C Advocacy in Action: Healthcare Policy Training for Global Health Champions FACILITATORS — Anne Danhoffer, Director of Partnership and Movement building, CARE International — Adjoa Kyerematen, Chief Executive Officer, Ghana Diaspora Public Affairs Collective (GHPAC)		CARPENTER B
	D Leading the Future: Health Equity, Innovation, and the Next Generation of Global Health Leadership — Dr. Katie Boston-Leary, Senior VP of Equity and Engagement, American Nurses Enterprise — Dr. Stacy Bentil, Founder, Bentil Leadership Institute, Director of Leadership Development, Ghanaian-Diaspora Nursing Alliance		N130 & N140
5:00 PM	Day 1 Wrap-Up & Evening Free <i>Optional informal networking dinners</i>	CLOSE	

DAY TWO Saturday, August 22, 2026

TIME	SESSION	FORMAT	LOCATION
7:30 AM	Morning Networking Breakfast & Visit Exhibits	NETWORKING	HUB
8:00 AM	Controlling Hypertension in African Descent Populations: Local and Global Perspectives Dr. George Mensah , Director, Center for Translation Research and Implementation Science (CTRIS), National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute (NHLBI), National Institutes of Health	KEYNOTE	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM
8:30 AM – 9:30 AM	Featured Panel — Innovative Strategies to Control Hypertension Across the Diaspora MODERATOR — Dr. Eunice Cromwell , Healthcare Leader, Director of Community & Member Engagement, A-DNA USA PANELISTS — Dr. Lisa Cooper , Director, Johns Hopkins Center for Health Equity, Bloomberg Distinguished Professor, Johns Hopkins Schools of Nursing, Medicine and Public Health — Dr. Serina Gbaba , Cardiovascular Nurse Practitioner, Meritus Health, Co-Director of Education, Ghanaian-Diaspora Nursing Alliance — Dr. Bunmi Ogungbe , Assistant Professor, Johns Hopkins Schools of Nursing and Public Health — Dr. Levette Owusu-Ansah , Interim National President, Ghana Pharmacist Association – North America	PANEL	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM
9:45 AM – 10:45 AM	Transitional Care Panel — Bridging the Gap: Advancing Transitional Care Across the Continuum MODERATOR — Cynthia Jones-Quartey , Founder and Program Director, Nascent Community Healthcare Network PANELISTS — Dr. Danah Jack , Founder & CEO, Metro Health & Rehab — Dr. Sid Patel , Co- Founder, Wellrock Pharmacy — Natoe Goba , CEO & Service Director, Aveon Health Services	PANEL	ALUMNI AUDITORIUM

TIME	SESSION	FORMAT	LOCATION
11:00 AM – 3:00 PM	Community Health Fair HOST Redeemers Church of Christ	HEALTH FAIR	10001 Aerospace Rd. Lanham, MD 20706
5:00 PM – 8:30 PM	A-DNA Fundraising Reception An elegant evening celebrating excellence in African diaspora health — featuring dinner, awards, and opportunities to invest in A-DNA’s global mission. KEYNOTE: Dr. Kofi Boahene, Professor of Otolaryngology–Head and Neck Surgery and Dermatology; Johns Hopkins Medicine, Founder, West Africa Institute for Special Surgery (WAISS)	RECEPTION	HUB